

FOR CREATIVE STRATEGISTS

Why clients hire you without ever asking for a portfolio.

They hire the person who can show them how they think. Here is how to show your thinking on one page.

• Ad teardown

• Strategy doc

• One-hour test

@csos

Swipe →

WHAT A PORTFOLIO CAN AND CANNOT DO

CAN DO

Show you have done work in the past.

CANNOT DO

Show you can do this job for this business today.

WHAT PROSPECTS ACTUALLY READ

A breakdown of their current work.

A one-page document for their next move.

A short recording of the first three things you would do for them.

A short recording of the first three things you would do for them.

03

TYPE 1. THE TEARDOWN

Screenshot one of their ads.

Write three sentences covering what you see, what you would test next, and what you expect to happen.

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TYPE 2. THE STRATEGY DOC

One page, written for them.

Who the ad is for. Why it is selling now. What you would push harder on.

No rate, no ask, no services page.

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TYPE 3. THE WALKTHROUGH

A three-minute recording with your camera off and your screen on.

Talk through the first three moves you would make if they signed you this week.

Talk through the first three moves you would make if they signed you this week.

03

THE RULE

Send it before they ask.

The creative strategists who get hired are the ones who send the thinking first, unsolicited, and without a services page attached.

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NEXT STEP

Not sure which of the three fits where you are?

Take the creative strategy test.

→ adscreativestrategy.com/quiz